

Word family: profit / profits / profited / profiting / profitable / profitably / profitability / unprofitable / nonprofit / non-profit / not-for-profit / for-profit / profiteer / profiteering

Base word: profit

Part of speech: mainly **noun** and **verb**

Related forms:

- **profit** (n.) — 利潤; 盈利; 收益; 好處
- **profit** (v.) — 獲利; 從.....得益; 受益
- **profitable** (adj.) — 有利可圖的; 盈利的; 有益的
- **profitably** (adv.) — 有利可圖地; 有效益地
- **profitability** (n.) — 盈利能力; 獲利能力
- **unprofitable** (adj.) — 無利可圖的; 虧損/不賺錢的
- **nonprofit / non-profit** (adj./n.) — 非牟利的; 非牟利機構
- **not-for-profit** (adj./n.) — 非牟利的; 非牟利組織
- **for-profit** (adj.) — 牟利的; 以盈利為目的的
- **profiteer** (n./v.) — 牟取暴利者; 趁機牟取暴利
- **profiteering** (n.) — 趁機牟取暴利; 哄抬牟利

Major useful extensions:

make a profit, earn a profit, generate a profit, turn a profit, return a profit,
record/report/post a profit, profit rises/falls, gross profit, net profit, operating profit,
pre-tax profit, after-tax profit, profit before tax, profit after tax, annual profit, quarterly
profit, total profit, profit margin, profit growth, profit forecast, profit target, profit warning,
profit figure, profit level, profit centre, profit-sharing, profit motive, profit maximisation,
profit-making, profit-driven, profit-seeking, profit-oriented, profit from something, profit
by doing something, profit from experience, profit from someone's misfortune, profit at
someone's expense, for profit, at a profit, sell at a profit, nonprofit organisation,
not-for-profit organisation, for-profit company, accounting profit, economic profit, normal
profit, supernormal/abnormal profit, paper profit, realised/unrealised profit, windfall
profit, trading profit, take profit, lock in profits, profit and loss / P&L, profitable business,
profitable customer, profitable product, profitable investment, profitable discussion,
profitability analysis, improve profitability, restore profitability, unprofitable business
line, profiteering.

Meaning in this passage

The aim is not to **give away profit**, but to reduce frustration, rebuild confidence and protect repeat business.

Here, **profit** means:

the money a business keeps after the relevant costs of earning its revenue have been deducted — 利潤; 盈利

Chris is saying:

the proposed returns policy is **not intended to sacrifice the company's earnings unnecessarily**.

The phrase **give away profit** is somewhat figurative. It means:

讓本來可以保留的盈利白白流失／犧牲盈利

中文翻譯：

目的並不是要白白犧牲盈利，而是要減少顧客挫折感、重建信心，並保障回頭生意。

So here:

profit = 公司從銷售所得收入扣除相關成本後剩下的盈利

A. PROFIT = BUSINESS EARNINGS AFTER COSTS

1. profit = money remaining after costs — 利潤; 盈利

This is the exact passage branch.

Practice 1 — original sentence

The aim is not to **give away profit**.

目的不是要白白犧牲盈利。

Practice 2

The company made a healthy **profit** last year.

公司去年錄得可觀盈利。

Practice 3

Higher sales do not automatically mean higher profit.

更高銷售額並不一定代表更高利潤。

MCQ-ready definition:

profit = 營業收入扣除相關成本和開支後剩下的金額

2. make a profit — 賺取盈利; 獲利

One of the most important collocations.

Practice 1

The business **made a profit** in its first year.

這家公司第一年已經錄得盈利。

Practice 2

A company can increase sales without making a profit.

公司可以增加銷售額, 卻仍然沒有盈利。

3. earn a profit — 賺取利潤

Practice 1

The retailer **earned a profit** despite higher delivery costs.

儘管送貨成本上升，零售商仍然賺取盈利。

Practice 2

Investors expect businesses to earn a reasonable profit.

投資者通常期望企業能賺取合理利潤。

4. generate a profit — 產生盈利

From your earlier **generate** family.

Practice 1

The new product has not yet **generated a profit**.

新產品仍未產生盈利。

Practice 2

High demand does not guarantee that a product will generate profit.

需求高不保證產品一定能帶來盈利。

5. turn a profit — 開始／成功錄得盈利

A major business idiom.

Practice 1

The company finally **turned a profit**.

公司終於轉虧為盈／錄得盈利。

Practice 2

It took the new store two years to turn a profit.

新店花了兩年才開始賺錢。

MCQ-ready definition:

turn a profit = 經營後最終錄得正數盈利，尤其由虧損轉為賺錢

6. return a profit — 帶來盈利

From your earlier **return** entry.

Practice 1

The investment eventually **returned a profit**.

這項投資最終帶來盈利。

Practice 2

The new division has yet to return a profit.

新事業部仍未錄得盈利。

B. RECORD / REPORT / POST A PROFIT

7. record a profit — 錄得盈利

Practice 1

The company **recorded a profit** of \$2 million.

公司錄得二百萬元盈利。

Practice 2

The division recorded its first annual profit.

該事業部錄得首個年度盈利。

8. report a profit — 報告／公布盈利

Practice 1

The retailer **reported a quarterly profit**.

零售商公布了季度盈利。

Practice 2

The company reported higher profits than expected.

公司公布的盈利高於預期。

9. post a profit — 錄得盈利

Common in financial/business journalism.

Practice 1

The group **posted a strong profit**.

集團錄得強勁盈利。

Practice 2

The business posted a profit after two years of losses.

企業在連續兩年虧損後終於錄得盈利。

10. profit rises / falls — 盈利上升／下降

Practice 1

Profit **rose sharply** in the second half.

下半年盈利大幅上升。

Practice 2

Rising return costs caused profit to fall.

退貨成本上升令盈利下降。

C. PROFIT VS LOSS

11. profit and loss — 盈利與虧損

Practice 1

The report compares **profit and loss** across the divisions.

報告比較各事業部的盈虧情況。

Practice 2

Every business must monitor both revenue and profit or loss.

每間企業都需要監察收入以及盈利或虧損。

12. operate at a profit — 盈利經營

Practice 1

The store is now **operating at a profit**.

這間店現在正有盈利地經營。

Practice 2

The service cannot continue unless it operates at a profit.

除非服務能錄得盈利，否則難以持續。

13. operate at a loss — 虧本經營

Natural opposite.

Practice 1

The branch has been **operating at a loss**.

分店一直虧本經營。

Practice 2

Selling below cost may mean operating at a loss.

低於成本價出售可能意味著虧本經營。

D. GROSS PROFIT

14. gross profit — 毛利

A major accounting/business term.

Practice 1

Gross profit increased as sourcing costs fell.

採購成本下降後，毛利上升。

Practice 2

Gross profit is not the same as net profit.

毛利並不等於淨利潤。

MCQ-ready definition:

gross profit = 通常指銷售收入扣除直接與所售商品／服務相關的成本後的盈利；具體會計呈列依制度而定

15. gross profit figure — 毛利數字

Practice 1

The gross profit figure improved.

毛利數字有所改善。

Practice 2

High return costs can affect gross profit.

高昂的退貨成本可能影響毛利。

E. NET PROFIT

16. net profit — 淨利潤；淨盈利

Practice 1

The company reported a **net profit** of \$500,000.

公司錄得五十萬元淨盈利。

Practice 2

Net profit takes account of more expenses than gross profit.

淨利潤計入的開支通常比毛利更多。

MCQ-ready definition:

net profit = 扣除相關成本、營運開支、稅項等後最終剩下的盈利，具體計算依會計口徑而定

17. net profit after tax — 稅後淨利潤

Practice 1

Net profit after tax increased.

稅後淨盈利上升。

Practice 2

Investors often examine net profit alongside cash flow.

投資者常把淨盈利和現金流一起分析。

F. OPERATING PROFIT

18. operating profit — 營業利潤; 營運盈利

Practice 1

Operating profit improved despite weak sales growth.

儘管銷售增長疲弱，營業利潤有所改善。

Practice 2

Operating profit focuses on profit from core operations before certain financing and tax items.

營業利潤主要反映核心營運活動的盈利。

MCQ-ready definition:

operating profit = 主要業務營運活動所產生的盈利，通常在融資成本和所得稅等某些項目前計算

G. PRE-TAX / AFTER-TAX PROFIT

19. pre-tax profit / profit before tax — 稅前盈利

Practice 1

Pre-tax profit rose by 8%.

稅前盈利上升百分之八。

Practice 2

The report shows profit before tax separately.

報告分開列出稅前利潤。

20. after-tax profit / profit after tax — 稅後盈利

Practice 1

Profit after tax was lower than expected.

稅後盈利低於預期。

Practice 2

Tax changes can affect after-tax profit without changing operating performance.

稅制變化可以影響稅後盈利，即使營運表現沒有改變。

H. ANNUAL / QUARTERLY / TOTAL PROFIT

21. annual profit — 年度盈利

Practice 1

Annual profit reached a record level.

年度盈利創新高。

Practice 2

Higher return rates reduced annual profit.

較高退貨率降低了全年盈利。

22. quarterly profit — 季度盈利

Practice 1

Quarterly profit fell slightly.

季度盈利輕微下降。

Practice 2

The company publishes quarterly profit figures.

公司公布季度盈利數字。

23. total profit — 總盈利

Practice 1

Total profit depends on both margin and sales volume.

總盈利取決於利潤水平和銷售量等因素。

Practice 2

The pilot may reduce profit per transaction but protect total profit through repeat purchases.

試行政策可能降低每宗交易的盈利，卻透過回頭購買保障整體盈利。

This is very relevant to your passage's argument.

I. PROFIT MARGIN

24. profit margin — 利潤率; 利潤空間

A core business term.

Practice 1

Returns can reduce the retailer's **profit margin**.

退貨可能降低零售商的利潤率。

Practice 2

Fast-fashion businesses may operate on relatively tight profit margins.

快時尚企業可能以較窄的利潤空間經營。

MCQ-ready definition:

profit margin = 盈利相對於收入／售價等基數的比例; 具體可指不同會計層次的 **margin**

You have already curated **margin**, so this is a compound rather than a reason to reopen that family.

25. high / low profit margin — 高／低利潤率

Practice 1

Luxury products may have higher profit margins.

奢侈品可能具有較高利潤率。

Practice 2

A low-margin product can still produce large total profit if sales volume is high.

低利潤率產品如果銷售量高，仍可能帶來大量總盈利。

J. PROFIT GROWTH / TARGET / FORECAST

26. profit growth — 盈利增長

Practice 1

The company expects slower **profit growth**.

公司預計盈利增長將放慢。

Practice 2

Repeat customers can support long-term profit growth.

回頭客可以支持長期盈利增長。

27. profit target — 盈利目標

Practice 1

The division missed its **profit target**.

事業部未能達到盈利目標。

Practice 2

Managers should not pursue profit targets at the expense of customer trust.

管理人員不應為了追求盈利目標而犧牲顧客信任。

28. profit forecast — 盈利預測

Practice 1

Management revised its **profit forecast**.

管理層修訂了盈利預測。

Practice 2

Higher return costs affected the forecast.

更高退貨成本影響了盈利預測。

29. profit warning — 盈利預警

A major business/stock-market expression.

Practice 1

The company issued a **profit warning**.

公司發出盈利預警。

Practice 2

A profit warning tells investors that expected profit is likely to be materially below earlier expectations.

盈利預警表示預期盈利可能明顯低於先前預期。

K. PROFIT CENTRE

30. profit centre / profit center — 利潤中心

An important management-accounting term.

Practice 1

Each regional division operates as a **profit centre**.

每個地區事業部都作為一個利潤中心運作。

Practice 2

A profit centre is evaluated partly on the profit it generates.

利潤中心的表現會部分按照其產生的盈利來評估。

MCQ-ready definition:

profit centre = 企業內可相對獨立計算收入、成本和盈利的業務單位

Important distinction: profit centre vs cost centre

profit centre

responsible for generating revenue/profit.

cost centre

primarily incurs and manages costs.

A warehouse may be treated as a cost centre, while a sales division may be a profit centre, depending on company structure.

L. PROFIT-SHARING

31. profit-sharing — 利潤分享；分紅制度

Practice 1

Employees participate in a **profit-sharing scheme**.

員工參與利潤分享／分紅計劃。

Practice 2

Profit-sharing links some employee rewards to company profitability.

利潤分享制度把部分員工報酬與公司盈利表現連繫起來。

32. share profits — 分享／分配盈利

Practice 1

The partners agreed to **share the profits equally**.

合夥人同意平均分配盈利。

Practice 2

Some companies share profits with employees through bonuses.

一些公司透過獎金與員工分享盈利。

M. PROFIT MOTIVE

33. profit motive — 牟利動機; 盈利動機

Practice 1

The **profit motive** influences many commercial decisions.

盈利動機會影響很多商業決策。

Practice 2

A profit motive does not automatically mean customer interests are ignored.

企業有盈利動機並不自動代表顧客利益會被忽視。

MCQ-ready definition:

profit motive = 希望賺取盈利而推動經濟／商業行動的動機

34. profit maximisation / maximization — 利潤最大化

Practice 1

Short-term **profit maximisation** may conflict with long-term customer loyalty.

短期利潤最大化可能與長期顧客忠誠衝突。

Practice 2

Firms do not always pursue pure profit maximisation.

企業並不一定只追求利潤最大化。

N. PROFIT-MAKING / PROFITABLE

35. profit-making = making money/profit — 賺錢的; 牟利的

Practice 1

The service became **profit-making** after two years.

這項服務兩年後開始錄得盈利。

Practice 2

The company closed several non-profit-making activities.

公司關閉了數項無法帶來盈利的業務。

36. profitable = producing profit — 有利可圖的; 盈利的

Practice 1

The product is highly **profitable**.

這項產品利潤豐厚。

Practice 2

Repeat customers are often more profitable over the long term.

回頭客長遠而言通常能帶來更高盈利價值。

MCQ-ready definition:

profitable = 能產生多於相關成本的盈利

37. profitable business — 盈利業務

Practice 1

The retailer built a profitable online business.

零售商建立了一盤有盈利的網上業務。

Practice 2

A profitable business still needs to control costs.

即使是賺錢的企業也需要控制成本。

38. profitable product — 高盈利／有利可圖的產品

Practice 1

This is one of our most **profitable products**.

這是我們最有利可圖的產品之一。

Practice 2

High sales do not necessarily make a product profitable.

銷量高不一定令產品有盈利。

39. profitable customer — 高盈利價值的顧客

Practice 1

Loyal repeat customers can be highly **profitable customers**.

忠誠回頭客可能是非常有盈利價值的顧客。

Practice 2

Profitability should be assessed over the whole customer relationship.

應從整段顧客關係評估其盈利價值。

40. profitable investment — 有盈利的投資

Practice 1

The investment proved highly **profitable**.

這項投資證明非常有利可圖。

Practice 2

A profitable investment can still involve risk.

有利可圖的投資仍可能涉及風險。

O. PROFITABLE = USEFUL / BENEFICIAL, NOT FINANCIAL

41. profitable = useful, productive, beneficial — 有益的; 富有成果的

A genuinely distinct figurative adjective branch.

Practice 1

We had a **profitable discussion** about the policy.

我們就政策進行了一場很有成果的討論。

Practice 2

She spent the afternoon in profitable study.

她下午進行了富有成效的學習。

MCQ-ready definition:

profitable = formal: 帶來有價值成果或益處的, 不一定涉及金錢盈利

This sense is much less common than financial **profitable**, but still modern and useful for recognition.

Important distinction: profitable discussion

It does **not** mean:

the discussion itself earned money.

It means:

productive / useful / beneficial discussion

Natural Traditional Chinese:

富有成果的討論

P. PROFITABILITY

42. profitability = ability/degree of producing profit — 盈利能力

Practice 1

The company is reviewing the **profitability** of its returns policy.

公司正在檢討退貨政策對盈利能力的影響。

Practice 2

Higher sales do not guarantee profitability.

更高銷售額並不保證能夠盈利。

MCQ-ready definition:

profitability = 一間企業、產品、顧客或投資持續產生盈利的能力／程度

43. improve profitability — 提高盈利能力

Practice 1

Better inventory control may **improve profitability**.

更好的庫存控制可能提高盈利能力。

Practice 2

Repeat business can improve long-term profitability.

回頭生意可以改善長期盈利能力。

44. restore profitability — 恢復盈利能力

Practice 1

The restructuring aims to **restore profitability**.

重組旨在恢復盈利能力。

Practice 2

Cost reductions alone may not restore profitability.

單靠削減成本未必可以恢復盈利。

45. profitability analysis — 盈利能力分析

Practice 1

Management carried out a **profitability analysis**.

管理層進行了盈利能力分析。

Practice 2

Customer profitability analysis may consider revenue, servicing costs and returns.

顧客盈利能力分析可能考慮收入、服務成本和退貨等因素。

Q. PROFITABLY

46. profitably = in a way that makes profit — 有盈利地

Practice 1

The company can operate **profitably** at this scale.

公司在這個規模下可以有盈利地經營。

Practice 2

The product cannot be sold profitably at that price.

產品以那個價格出售便無利可圖。

47. profitably = beneficially/usefully — 有成效地

Less common figurative branch.

Practice 1

The time could be spent more **profitably** elsewhere.

這段時間在其他事情上可能可以運用得更有價值。

Practice 2

We used the meeting time profitably.

我們把會議時間運用得很有成效。

R. UNPROFITABLE

48. unprofitable = not producing enough profit — 無利可圖的; 不賺錢的

Practice 1

The company closed an **unprofitable store**.

公司關閉了一間虧損／不賺錢的店舖。

Practice 2

High return costs can make a product unprofitable.

高昂的退貨成本可能令產品變得無利可圖。

MCQ-ready definition:

unprofitable = 所產生的收入不足以帶來合理盈利，甚至可能造成虧損

49. unprofitable customer / account — 盈利價值低或造成虧損的顧客／帳戶

Practice 1

Some accounts may become unprofitable because servicing costs are very high.

部分帳戶可能因服務成本太高而變得無盈利價值。

Practice 2

Businesses should be careful about labelling customers simply as “unprofitable.”

企業在把顧客簡單標為 **unprofitable** 時應很謹慎。

50. unprofitable business line — 虧損業務線

Practice 1

Management reviewed each **unprofitable business line**.

管理層檢討每項無利可圖的業務線。

Practice 2

The division stopped several persistently unprofitable activities.

事業部停止了數項長期不賺錢的業務活動。

S. PROFIT AS A VERB = MAKE MONEY

51. profit from something = make money from it — 從.....獲利

Practice 1

The company **profits from** repeat purchases.

公司從回頭購買中獲利。

Practice 2

Some businesses profit from high-volume sales.

有些企業從大量銷售中賺取盈利。

MCQ-ready definition:

profit from X = 因 X 而取得金錢盈利

52. profit by selling/buying something — 透過.....獲利

Practice 1

The seller profited by buying cheaply and selling at a higher price.

賣家透過低買高賣獲利。

Practice 2

The firm profited from strong demand.

公司因強勁需求而獲得盈利。

Usage note:

Modern English generally strongly favors:

profit from X

profit by doing X is also possible, especially when explaining the means.

T. PROFIT = BENEFIT, NOT NECESSARILY MONEY

53. profit from something = gain a useful benefit — 從.....得益

A genuinely distinct verb sense.

Practice 1

We can **profit from our past mistakes**.

我們可以從過去的錯誤中得到教訓／得益。

Practice 2

Students **profit from constructive feedback**.

學生會從具建設性的意見中受益。

MCQ-ready definition:

profit from X = 從 X 得到有用的知識、經驗或其他好處, 而不一定是金錢

54. profit from experience — 從經驗中獲益

Practice 1

Good managers **profit from experience**.

優秀管理人員懂得從經驗中學習得益。

Practice 2

The company should profit from what it learned during the pilot.

公司應該善用試行期所得經驗。

55. profit by someone's advice/example — 因別人的意見／例子而受益

Practice 1

We profited by her advice.

我們從她的建議中受益。

Practice 2

Younger employees can profit from experienced colleagues' guidance.

年輕員工可以從資深同事的指導中獲益。

This is somewhat more formal/less common than:

benefit from.

U. PROFIT FROM SOMEONE'S MISFORTUNE

56. profit from someone's misfortune — 從別人的不幸中獲利

Often morally negative.

Practice 1

It would be wrong to **profit from someone's misfortune**.

從別人的不幸中牟利是不恰當的。

Practice 2

Critics accused traders of profiting from the shortage.

批評者指交易商利用短缺牟利。

MCQ-ready definition:

profit from someone's misfortune = 利用別人的困境取得金錢或其他利益

57. profit at someone's expense — 以損害別人為代價獲利

Practice 1

A business should not **profit at customers' expense** through misleading information.

企業不應透過誤導資訊犧牲顧客利益來牟利。

Practice 2

One department should not profit at another's expense.

一個部門不應以另一個部門受損為代價來獲益。

Here **profit** may be literal financial gain or broader advantage.

V. FOR PROFIT

58. for profit = with the intention of making money — 以牟利為目的

Practice 1

The goods were bought for resale **for profit**.

這批貨品被購入轉售，目的是賺取盈利。

Practice 2

The activity is carried out for profit.

這項活動是以牟利為目的進行。

59. sell at a profit — 有利潤地出售

Practice 1

The retailer bought the stock cheaply and sold it **at a profit**.

零售商低價入貨後以盈利價格出售。

Practice 2

The property was later sold at a substantial profit.

物業其後出售時賺取了可觀盈利。

MCQ-ready definition:

sell at a profit = 售價高於相關成本，因此出售後有盈利

60. sell at a loss — 虧本出售

Natural contrast.

Practice 1

Unsold stock was eventually sold **at a loss**.

未售出的庫存最終虧本出售。

Practice 2

Heavy discounting may force retailers to sell at a loss.

大幅減價可能迫使零售商蝕本出售。

W. NONPROFIT / NON-PROFIT

61. nonprofit / non-profit = organised primarily for purposes other than distributing profit to owners — 非牟利的

A major institutional branch.

Practice 1

She works for a **nonprofit organisation**.

她在一間非牟利機構工作。

Practice 2

Nonprofit organisations can still receive revenue and may have financial surpluses.

非牟利機構仍可以有收入，也可能出現盈餘。

MCQ-ready definition:

nonprofit = 主要目的不是把盈利分派給擁有者／投資者，而是把資源用於組織宗旨的機構模式；具體法律定義依司法管轄區而異

62. a nonprofit — 非牟利機構

Especially AmE.

Practice 1

The charity operates as **a nonprofit**.

該慈善機構以非牟利機構形式運作。

Practice 2

She founded a nonprofit supporting education.

她創辦了一間支援教育的非牟利組織。

63. nonprofit sector — 非牟利界別

Practice 1

She moved from banking into the **nonprofit sector**.

她由銀行業轉到非牟利界別工作。

Practice 2

Nonprofit organisations often depend on several sources of funding.

非牟利機構通常依賴多種資金來源。

Important distinction: nonprofit does not mean “no money”

A nonprofit may:

- charge fees,

- earn revenue,
- pay employees,
- accumulate reserves,
- generate a surplus.

The key distinction is usually about:

purpose and distribution of earnings

not:

“the organisation must never receive more money than it spends.”

X. NOT-FOR-PROFIT

64. not-for-profit = operated for a purpose other than distributing profit — 非牟利的

Practice 1

The centre is run on a **not-for-profit basis**.

中心以非牟利模式運作。

Practice 2

It is a not-for-profit organisation.

這是一間非牟利機構。

Important distinction: nonprofit vs not-for-profit

In everyday English they often overlap heavily.

Legal/accounting distinctions, where any exist, depend on jurisdiction and organisational form.

For general learners:

both broadly mean 非牟利

unless a specific legal context defines them differently.

Y. FOR-PROFIT

65. for-profit = operated to produce profits for owners/investors — 牟利的

Practice 1

Fast Fashion is a **for-profit business**.

Fast Fashion 是一間牟利企業。

Practice 2

For-profit and nonprofit organisations may pursue different financial objectives.

牟利與非牟利機構的財務目標可能不同。

MCQ-ready definition:

for-profit = 以產生盈利並可把收益歸屬／分配給擁有者或投資者為商業目的之一的

66. for-profit company — 牟利公司

Practice 1

A for-profit company must still comply with consumer rules.

牟利公司仍然需要遵守消費者規則。

Practice 2

Being for-profit does not mean ignoring long-term customer relationships.

企業以牟利為目的並不等於可以忽視長期顧客關係。

Z. PROFIT-DRIVEN / PROFIT-ORIENTED / PROFIT-SEEKING

67. profit-driven = strongly motivated by profit — 利潤導向的

Practice 1

The decision appeared excessively **profit-driven**.

這項決定看來過分以盈利為導向。

Practice 2

Profit-driven decisions may still consider long-term customer trust.

盈利導向的決策仍可以考慮長期顧客信任。

68. profit-oriented — 以盈利為導向的

Practice 1

The company is commercially **profit-oriented**.

公司在商業上以盈利為導向。

Practice 2

Profit-oriented management focuses strongly on financial performance.

盈利導向管理十分重視財務表現。

69. profit-seeking — 追求盈利的

Practice 1

The firm is a **profit-seeking enterprise**.

該企業是一間追求盈利的公司。

Practice 2

Profit-seeking behaviour is not identical to illegal profiteering.

追求盈利的行為不等於非法或不當的暴利行為。

AA. PROFITEER

70. profiteer = person/business making excessive or unfair profit from abnormal conditions — 趁機牟取暴利者

A strong negative derivative.

Practice 1

Critics accused some sellers of being **profiteers**.

批評者指部分賣家是趁機牟取暴利者。

Practice 2

Profiteers may exploit shortages or emergencies to charge excessive prices.

牟取暴利者可能利用短缺或緊急情況收取過高價格。

MCQ-ready definition:

profiteer = 利用短缺、危機、戰亂等特殊情況不合理牟取高額利益的人／商戶

71. profiteer as a verb — 趁機牟取暴利

Practice 1

The company was accused of **profiteering** from the shortage.

公司被指利用短缺情況牟取暴利。

Practice 2

Authorities investigated whether traders had profiteered.

當局調查交易商是否曾趁機牟取暴利。

AB. PROFITEERING

72. profiteering = making excessive/unfair profits — 趁機牟取暴利

Practice 1

The government introduced measures against **profiteering**.

有關方面推出措施打擊趁機牟取暴利。

Practice 2

Sudden price increases led to accusations of profiteering.

價格突然上升，引起哄抬牟利的指控。

MCQ-ready definition:

profiteering = 尤其利用危機、供應短缺或他人困境取得不合理高額盈利的行為

Important distinction 1: profit vs revenue

This is absolutely essential.

revenue

money coming into the business from sales/operations **before many costs are deducted.**

profit

what remains **after relevant costs are deducted.**

Example:

Revenue = \$1,000,000

Costs = \$900,000

Profit = \$100,000

So:

high revenue ≠ high profit.

Important distinction 2: profit vs sales

sales

value/volume of goods sold.

profit

financial gain remaining after costs.

A company can have:

record sales + very low profit

if costs are also very high.

Important distinction 3: profit vs income

Income is broader and context-dependent.

For an individual:

salary/investment income.

For accounting/business, **income** can have technical meanings.

Profit more specifically emphasizes:

financial excess after relevant costs

Do not treat all **income** as profit.

Important distinction 4: profit vs cash

profit

accounting measure.

cash

actual money/cash equivalents available or moving.

A profitable company can still experience cash-flow difficulty.

This distinction is extremely important in business.

Important distinction 5: profit vs cash flow

profit

earnings after costs under accounting rules.

cash flow

actual cash entering and leaving over time.

A sale made on credit can contribute to profit before the cash is collected.

Important distinction 6: profit vs return

From your previous word.

profit

absolute gain/earnings.

return

investment gain, often considered relative to capital invested.

Example:

\$10,000 profit

but:

10% return on investment.

Important distinction 7: profit vs margin

profit

amount of earnings.

profit margin

profit expressed relative to a base such as revenue.

Example:

profit = \$100
revenue = \$1,000
margin = 10%

So:

profit is an amount; margin is normally a ratio/percentage.

Important distinction 8: gross profit vs net profit

gross profit

subtracts a narrower set of directly related costs.

net profit

subtracts a broader range of expenses.

Therefore:

gross profit is normally higher than net profit,
assuming ordinary positive expense structure.

Important distinction 9: operating profit vs net profit

operating profit

focuses on operating activities.

net profit

includes a broader final set of items such as finance and tax effects under the relevant accounting presentation.

Do not treat them as identical.

Important distinction 10: profit vs earnings

In ordinary business journalism:

earnings

often means company profit, particularly accounting earnings.

But **earnings** can also mean:

an individual's pay/income.

So context matters.

Important distinction 11: profit vs surplus

profit

strongly associated with commercial/business earnings.

surplus

amount by which income/resources exceed expenditure/requirements and is often used by:

- nonprofit bodies,
- public bodies,
- budgets.

A nonprofit may report:

a surplus

rather than describe its purpose as generating profit for owners.

Important distinction 12: profit vs benefit

From your earlier **benefit** family:

profit

usually financial gain, though its verb can also mean benefit.

benefit

any advantage.

financial profit

盈利

health benefit

健康益處

In:

profit from experience

profit moves closer to:

benefit from experience.

Important distinction 13: profit as noun vs verb

Noun:

The company made a **profit**.

公司錄得盈利。

Verb:

The company **profited from** demand.
公司從需求中獲利。

Important distinction 14: profit from = earn money vs gain benefit

Two major verb readings:

Financial:

profit from rising prices
從價格上升中獲利

General benefit:

profit from experience
從經驗中受益

Context decides.

Important distinction 15: profit from vs benefit from

benefit from

neutral and very broad.

profit from

can mean:

- financial gain,
- or more formal “gain useful advantage.”

For non-financial everyday contexts:

benefit from feedback

is usually more natural than:

profit from feedback.

Important distinction 16: profit from vs exploit

From your earlier **exploit** family:

profit from X

simply gain benefit/money from X.

exploit X

use X to your advantage, sometimes unfairly.

profit from an opportunity
neutral

exploit vulnerable customers
negative

But:

profit from someone's misfortune

can itself carry a negative moral implication.

Important distinction 17: profit vs profiteering

profit

normal business earnings.

profiteering

excessive/unfair gain, particularly by taking advantage of abnormal conditions.

A business making profit is not thereby profiteering.

Important distinction 18: profitable vs profitable-looking

profitable

actually produces or is expected to produce profit.

profitable-looking

appears likely to be profitable.

Do not infer actual profitability solely from high sales or high prices.

Important distinction 19: profitable vs productive

Financial:

profitable product
賺錢產品

Figurative:

profitable discussion
富有成果的討論

For ordinary intellectual/work activities, **productive** is much more common than figurative **profitable**.

Important distinction 20: profitability vs profit

profit

actual amount/result.

profitability

capacity/degree of making profit.

A company may have:

profit this year

but weak long-term:

profitability.

Important distinction 21: profitability vs profit margin

profitability

broad concept of ability to earn profit.

profit margin

one specific type of profitability measure.

Margin can help assess profitability but is not the whole concept.

Important distinction 22: unprofitable vs loss-making

Very close.

unprofitable

does not produce satisfactory profit; may lose money.

loss-making

specifically incurs a loss.

Therefore:

unprofitable

can sometimes be broader than:

loss-making.

Important distinction 23: for-profit vs profitable

Critical:

for-profit

describes purpose/organisational model.

profitable

describes actual financial performance.

A for-profit company can be:

unprofitable.

And a nonprofit can:

generate a financial surplus.

Important distinction 24: nonprofit vs unprofitable

Completely different.

nonprofit

organisation's structural/purpose model.

unprofitable

financial performance is poor.

A nonprofit may be financially healthy.

A for-profit business may be unprofitable.

Important distinction 25: nonprofit vs charity

nonprofit

broad organisational category.

charity

more specific public-benefit/charitable status depending on jurisdiction.

Not every nonprofit is necessarily legally a charity.

Important distinction 26: profit motive vs greed

profit motive

ordinary economic/business desire to earn profit.

greed

excessive selfish desire for wealth/gain.

The profit motive is not automatically greed.

Important distinction 27: profit-driven vs profitable

profit-driven

describes motivation/decision-making.

profitable

describes financial outcome.

A company may be intensely profit-driven yet still fail to be profitable.

Important distinction 28: profit maximisation vs sustainable profitability

profit maximisation

push profit as high as possible under a particular objective/framework.

sustainable profitability

maintain healthy profit over the long term.

Your passage strongly favors the second kind of reasoning:

don't protect today's margin in a way that destroys repeat business tomorrow.

Important distinction 29: make a profit vs turn a profit

make a profit

general.

turn a profit

often highlights crossing from:

- loss / no profit
to:
- positive profit.

The shop made a profit again.
general.

The shop finally turned a profit.
implies previous difficulty.

Important distinction 30: at a profit vs for profit

sell at a profit

sell so that the transaction produces profit.

operate for profit

operate with profit-making as an organisational/commercial purpose.

at = financial result

for = intention/purpose

Important distinction 31: profit warning

A **profit warning** does not mean:

“Warning: the company has too much profit.”

It means:

the company warns investors that expected profit is likely to be worse than previously expected.

A classic lexicalized business expression.

Important distinction 32: profit-sharing vs dividend

From your previous **division/dividend** family:

profit-sharing

profits distributed according to an employee/partner scheme.

dividend

distribution made to shareholders in accordance with corporate arrangements.

Both distribute financial value, but to different roles and under different structures.

Important distinction 33: paper profit vs realised profit

73. paper profit = gain that exists on paper but has not yet been realised — 帳面盈利

Practice 1

The shares show a large **paper profit**.

股票目前有很大的帳面盈利。

Practice 2

Paper profits can disappear if prices fall before the asset is sold.

如果資產出售前價格下跌，帳面盈利可能消失。

74. realised profit — 已實現盈利

Practice 1

Selling the asset converted the paper gain into a **realised profit**.

出售資產把帳面收益變成已實現盈利。

Practice 2

Realised profit results from a completed transaction.

已實現盈利來自已完成的交易。

75. unrealised profit / gain — 未實現盈利

Practice 1

The portfolio contains substantial **unrealised profits**.

投資組合目前包含大量未實現盈利。

Practice 2

Unrealised profit may change as market prices change.

未實現盈利會隨市場價格變動。

Important distinction 34: paper profit ≠ cash received

A paper profit may exist because an asset's value rose.

Until sale/realisation:

the gain may not have produced cash.

So:

valuation gain ≠ cash inflow.

AC. WINDFALL PROFIT

76. windfall profit — 意外暴增盈利; 非預期巨額盈利

Practice 1

The price shock produced **windfall profits** for some firms.

價格衝擊令部分企業獲得意外巨額盈利。

Practice 2

Windfall profit usually arises from unusual external conditions rather than ordinary planned improvement.

意外盈利通常源於特殊外部環境，而不只是一般經營改善。

Important distinction: windfall profit vs profiteering

windfall profit

unexpected high profit due to circumstances.

profiteering

suggests unfair/excessive exploitation of circumstances.

A windfall profit is not automatically evidence of profiteering.

AD. ACCOUNTING PROFIT VS ECONOMIC PROFIT

77. accounting profit — 會計利潤

Practice 1

The firm reported a positive **accounting profit**.

公司錄得正的會計利潤。

Practice 2

Accounting profit uses recorded revenues and accounting expenses.

會計利潤按照會計上的收入和費用計算。

78. economic profit — 經濟利潤

Practice 1

A company can earn accounting profit but little or no **economic profit**.

公司可以錄得會計盈利，但經濟利潤很少甚至為零。

Practice 2

Economic profit considers opportunity costs in addition to explicit costs.

經濟利潤除了明確成本外，也考慮機會成本。

MCQ-ready definition:

economic profit = 經濟學上把顯性成本和相關機會成本都計入後所得的盈利概念

Important distinction: accounting profit vs economic profit

Accounting:

revenue – recorded accounting expenses

Economic:

revenue – explicit costs – relevant opportunity costs

So economic profit may be lower.

AE. NORMAL / SUPERNORMAL PROFIT

79. normal profit — 正常利潤

An economics term.

Practice 1

In economics, **normal profit** is treated as part of the opportunity cost of keeping resources in their current use.

在經濟學中，正常利潤可視為令資源繼續留在目前用途所需回報的一部分。

Practice 2

Normal profit is not the same as zero accounting profit.

正常利潤並不同會計上的零盈利。

80. supernormal / abnormal profit — 超額利潤

Practice 1

Firms may earn **supernormal profits** when barriers to entry are high.

當市場進入障礙高時，企業可能取得超額利潤。

Practice 2

The term compares actual economic profit with the normal-profit benchmark.

這個概念把實際經濟利潤與正常利潤基準比較。

AF. PROFIT AND LOSS / P&L

81. profit and loss / P&L — 損益; 盈虧

Practice 1

Managers reviewed the monthly **profit and loss statement**.

管理人員檢視每月損益表。

Practice 2

Return costs appear somewhere within the company's P&L according to its accounting treatment.

退貨成本會按公司的會計處理方式反映在損益資料中。

MCQ-ready definition:

profit and loss / P&L = 彙總企業收入、成本和開支以顯示一定期間盈虧表現的財務概念／報表

82. P&L responsibility — 損益責任

Practice 1

The division head has **P&L responsibility**.

事業部主管負有損益責任。

Practice 2

Managers with P&L responsibility are accountable for both revenue and costs.

負有損益責任的管理人員同時需要對收入和成本負責。

AG. TAKE PROFIT / LOCK IN PROFIT

83. take profit / take profits — 獲利了結

Common in investment/trading.

Practice 1

Some investors **took profits** after the price rose sharply.

價格大幅上升後，一些投資者獲利了結。

Practice 2

Traders may take profit when a target price is reached.

交易者可能在達到目標價時鎖定盈利。

84. lock in a profit / lock in profits — 鎖定盈利

Practice 1

She sold part of the position to **lock in a profit**.

她出售部分持倉以鎖定盈利。

Practice 2

An unrealised gain becomes realised when profit is locked in through a completed sale.

透過完成出售鎖定盈利後，未實現收益便轉為已實現收益。

Important distinction: take profit vs make profit

make a profit

business/investment earns profit.

take profit

trader/investor closes/reduces position to realise gain.

Different actions.

AH. COUNTABILITY

Important distinction 35: profit can be uncountable or countable

Uncountable/general concept:

The aim is to protect **profit**.
目標是保障盈利。

Countable result:

The company made **a profit**.
公司錄得一筆／一項盈利。

Plural:

profits increased.
盈利總額／各期盈利增加。

This differs from some strictly uncountable business nouns.

Important distinction 36: profit vs profits

profit

often general amount/concept.

profits

often company earnings across:

- periods,
- activities,
- or collectively.

profit fell 10%
盈利下降 10%

annual profits increased
年度盈利增加

Both can be natural.

AI. PROFIT IN YOUR PASSAGE

Your sentence is:

The aim is not to **give away profit**, but to reduce frustration, rebuild confidence and protect repeat business.

The writer is making a very important business argument:

Current strict policy:

fewer refunds today
→ seems to protect immediate profit

But it may also cause:

frustration
→ bad reviews
→ lost trust
→ fewer repeat purchases
→ lower future profit.

So Chris is **not arguing against profit**.

He is arguing about:

how profit is best protected over time.

The underlying contrast is:

short-term profit protection
vs
long-term profitability and repeat business

Important distinction 37: profit vs repeat business in the passage

A strict no-refund rule may protect money on one transaction.

But fair treatment may protect:

repeat business

which can create:

- future revenue,
- customer lifetime value,
- future profit.

So the letter treats customer fairness and profit as potentially:

complementary,

not necessarily opposites.

Important distinction 38: “give away profit”

This is not a fixed accounting term like:

gross profit

or:

net profit.

It is rhetorical business English:

give away profit = unnecessarily surrender money that the company could have retained

Similar ideas:

sacrifice profit
give up margin
leave money on the table

But each has slightly different nuances.

Important distinction 39: profit vs margin in the same passage

Later:

the current rule was perhaps introduced to protect our **margins**

Earlier:

the aim is not to give away **profit**

The concepts are related but not identical:

profit

the earnings amount.

margin

profit relative to sales/revenue/price or the financial room between selling price and costs.

The writer varies vocabulary intelligently rather than repeating the same concept.

Important distinction 40: profit vs customer confidence

The passage argues that:

profit today

should not be protected in a way that destroys:

customer confidence tomorrow.

This is an example of the distinction between:

immediate transaction economics

and

long-term customer economics.

Family-extension note

The **profit** family has several major modern branches:

1. basic business earnings

- make a profit
- record a profit

2. accounting layers

- gross profit
- operating profit
- net profit

3. tax timing

- pre-tax profit
- after-tax profit

4. period reporting

- annual profit
- quarterly profit

5. profitability measures

- profit margin
- profit growth

6. management targets

- profit target
- profit forecast
- profit warning

7. management accounting

- profit centre
- P&L responsibility

8. employee distribution

- profit-sharing

9. economic motivation

- profit motive
- profit maximisation

10. financial success adjective

- profitable business
- profitable product

11. non-financial usefulness

- profitable discussion

12. ability to make money

- profitability

13. negative financial result

- unprofitable

14. verb: financial gain

- profit from sales

15. verb: general benefit

- profit from experience

16. morally questionable gain

- profit from misfortune
- profit at someone's expense

17. organisational purpose

- for-profit
- nonprofit
- not-for-profit

18. decision orientation

- profit-driven
- profit-seeking

19. unfair excessive gain

- profiteer
- profiteering

20. investment gains

- paper profit
- realised profit
- take profits

21. unexpected gains

- windfall profit

22. economics

- accounting profit
- economic profit
- normal profit
- supernormal profit

23. financial reporting

- profit and loss / P&L

For your passage, the exact branch is:

profit = the company's financial gain remaining after the costs associated with doing business, which Chris argues should be protected intelligently rather than maximised through an excessively rigid returns policy

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea
profit	利潤; 盈利	passage sense
make a profit	賺取盈利	positive earnings
earn a profit	賺取利潤	earnings
generate a profit	產生盈利	business result
turn a profit	開始／轉為盈利	cross into profitability
return a profit	帶來盈利	result
record a profit	錄得盈利	reporting
report a profit	報告盈利	reporting
post a profit	錄得盈利	financial journalism
profit rises/falls	盈利上升／下降	trend
profit and loss	盈虧; 損益	reporting
operate at a profit	盈利經營	positive result
gross profit	毛利	accounting
net profit	淨盈利	accounting
operating profit	營業利潤	operations

pre-tax profit	稅前盈利	tax stage
profit after tax	稅後盈利	tax stage
annual profit	年度盈利	period
quarterly profit	季度盈利	period
total profit	總盈利	total
profit margin	利潤率	profitability measure
profit growth	盈利增長	trend
profit target	盈利目標	management
profit forecast	盈利預測	forecasting
profit warning	盈利預警	investor communication
profit centre	利潤中心	management accounting
profit-sharing	利潤分享／分紅	employee reward
profit motive	盈利動機	economics
profit maximisation	利潤最大化	economics
profit-making	盈利／牟利的	business
profitable	有利可圖的	financial success
profitable discussion	富有成果的討論	figurative benefit
profitability	盈利能力	capacity to profit
improve profitability	提高盈利能力	management
profitably	有盈利地／有成效地	adverb
unprofitable	無利可圖的	poor financial result
profit from X	從 X 獲利／受益	verb

profit from experience	從經驗中得益	non-financial
profit from misfortune	從他人不幸中牟利	negative
profit at someone's expense	犧牲別人利益來獲利	negative
for profit	以牟利為目的	purpose
sell at a profit	有盈利地出售	transaction
nonprofit / non-profit	非牟利的／機構	organisation
not-for-profit	非牟利的	organisation
for-profit	牟利的	organisation
profit-driven	盈利導向的	motivation
profit-oriented	以盈利為導向的	motivation
profit-seeking	追求盈利的	motivation
profiteer	牟取暴利者	unethical gain
profiteering	趁機牟取暴利	unethical gain
paper profit	帳面盈利	unrealised gain
realised profit	已實現盈利	completed gain
unrealised profit	未實現盈利	valuation gain
windfall profit	意外巨額盈利	unusual conditions
accounting profit	會計利潤	accounting
economic profit	經濟利潤	economics
normal profit	正常利潤	economics
supernormal profit	超額利潤	economics
P&L	損益	reporting

take profits	獲利了結	trading
lock in profits	鎖定盈利	trading

For your original sentence

The aim is not to **give away profit**, but to reduce frustration, rebuild confidence and protect repeat business.

Here:

profit = Fast Fashion 真正保留下來的商業盈利, 而 **Chris** 認為公司不應為了眼前每宗交易的短期盈利, 而破壞顧客信任和未來回頭購買所帶來的長期盈利

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

目的並不是要白白犧牲公司的盈利, 而是要減少顧客的挫折感、重建信心, 並保障回頭生意。

The cleanest learner contrast is:

sales = 賣了多少
revenue = 銷售／營運帶來多少收入
cost = 為取得收入付出了多少
profit = 扣除相關成本後剩下多少盈利
margin = 盈利相對於收入／售價等的比例
cash flow = 現金實際流入和流出
return = 投資產生的回報
profitability = 持續賺錢的能力

And the passage's business argument is especially important:

protecting profit on one sale
 is not necessarily the same as
protecting long-term profitability.

A rigid no-refund rule may preserve money **today**, while frustrated customers, bad reviews and lost repeat purchases may cost the business **more tomorrow**.